

Constitution of CMUnity

Article I: Organization Name

The name of this organization shall be **CMUnity**.

Article II: Mission and Principles

Section 1: Mission Statement

The mission of CMUnity is to foster a campus environment defined by connection, understanding, and active citizenship. We strive to bridge divides within the Carnegie Mellon University community by creating spaces for genuine human connection and constructive dialogue.

Section 2: Core Principles

This organization is founded upon and dedicated to the following principles:

- Breaking Cliques and Building Community:** We actively work to dismantle social silos and foster a unified, inclusive campus culture where every individual feels a sense of belonging.
- Spreading Respect, Solidarity, and Empathy:** We champion a culture of kindness and mutual understanding, standing in solidarity with one another and treating all individuals with dignity.
- Encouraging Civic Engagement:** We promote active participation in the democratic process and civic life, empowering students to be responsible and engaged members of society.
- Healing Polarization:** We seek to de-escalate social and political divisiveness by emphasizing shared humanity and common ground over partisan conflict.
- Facilitating Thoughtful, Nuanced Discussions:** We provide a platform for substantive conversations on complex issues, valuing depth, nuance, and critical thinking over soundbites and hostility.

Article III: Membership

Section 1: Eligibility

Membership in CMUnity is open to all registered students (undergraduate and graduate), faculty, staff, and alumni of Carnegie Mellon University.

Section 2: Active Membership

An active member is defined as an individual who:

- Attends at least three (3) meetings or events per semester.
- Upholds the principles of the organization, particularly regarding respect and empathy in discussions.

Section 3: Non-Discrimination

CMUnity will not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, gender identity, pregnancy, disability, age, ancestry, veteran status, genetic information, or sexual orientation. We are committed to ensuring the safety and respect of all members of the Carnegie Mellon community.

Section 4: Non-Hazing Statement

Hazing will not be used as a condition of membership in this organization. The organization will abide by all University policies regarding student conduct and safety.

Article IV: Officers

Section 1: Executive Board

The Executive Board shall consist of the God-Emperor, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Chief Operating Officer (COO), Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Envoy of Civic Pluralism, and Chief Envoy of Spiritual Solidarity.

Section 2: Duties

1. **God-Emperor:** Presides over meetings, represents the organization to the University and public, and oversees the general direction of the club to ensure fidelity to its principles.
2. **Vice-President:** Assists the God-Emperor, presides in their absence, and leads efforts specifically focused on community-building and "clique-breaking" initiatives.
3. **Secretary:** Maintains records of meetings (minutes), manages membership lists, and coordinates communication, ensuring transparency in all discussions.
4. **Treasurer:** Manages finances, keeps accurate accounts, and coordinates funding for events.
5. **Chief Operating Officer (COO):** Responsible for large-scale logistics, campus-wide community integration, and coordinating complex inter-group community-building events.
6. **Chief Technology Officer (CTO):** Responsible for digital infrastructure and maintaining platforms for nuanced dialogue. The CTO is specifically charged with managing the organization's website and may delegate technical tasks to trustworthy assistants as they see fit.
7. **Chief Envoy of Civic Pluralism:** Responsible for leading bipartisan initiatives, facilitating cross-partisan dialogue, and bridging political divides within the campus community.
8. **Chief Envoy of Spiritual Solidarity:** Responsible for leading interfaith initiatives, promoting religious pluralism, and building multi-faith community solidarity.

Section 3: Terms of Office

Officers shall serve for one academic year. Elections will be held in the Spring semester for the following year.

Article V: Elections

Section 1: Procedure

1. Elections shall be held annually during the Spring semester, typically at the second-to-last general meeting.

2. Any active member may nominate themselves or another active member for office.
3. Officers are elected by a simple majority vote of active members present at the election meeting.

Section 2: Voting

Voting shall be conducted by secret ballot to ensure fairness.

Section 3: Transition

The transition from old officers to new officers will take place during the final meeting of the Spring semester.

Article VI: Removal of Officers and Members

Section 1: Grounds for Removal

Officers or members may be removed for conduct that blatantly contradicts the core principles of the organization (e.g., harassment, fostering polarization, or engaging in discriminatory behavior) or for failure to perform duties.

Section 2: Process

1. A motion for removal must be brought by an active member and seconded.
2. The individual in question must be given the opportunity to speak in their defense.
3. Removal requires a two-thirds (2/3) supermajority vote of the voting members present.

Section 3: Appeals

The process for appeals can be initiated by either a member in good standing or by the individual removed with a sponsor who is a member in good standing. Appeals are heard by the remaining Executive Board and require a majority vote to be successful.

Article VII: Meetings

Section 1: General Meetings

General body meetings will be held regularly (at least monthly) during the academic year to facilitate discussions and community events.

Section 2: Emergency Meetings

The God-Emperor and Vice-President can call emergency meetings with a 24-hour notice to the active membership.

Section 3: Format

Meetings shall be structured to encourage dialogue. Moderators may be designated to ensure discussions remain respectful, nuanced, and productively align with the principle of healing polarization.

Article VIII: Finances

Section 1: Funding

CMUnity may raise funds through university funding, grants, or voluntary contributions.

Section 2: Expenditures

All funds must be used to further the mission of the organization. Expenditures must be authorized by the Treasurer and God-Emperor.

Article IX: Amendments

Section 1: Proposal

Amendments to this constitution may be proposed by any active member at a general meeting.

Section 2: Ratification

1. Proposed amendments must be presented at least one meeting prior to voting.
2. Ratification requires a two-thirds (2/3) vote of active members present.

Article X: Ratification

This Constitution shall become effective immediately upon a majority vote of the founding members of CMUnity.

Article XI: Institutional Continuity and Handovers

Section 1: Handover Mandate

To preserve organizational continuity and stability, all outgoing executive officers must facilitate a formal handover process for their successors. This process is designed to ensure that CMUnity retains all institutional knowledge, strategic resources, and operational assets across leadership transitions.

Section 2: Resource Management

The handover process must include the transfer of access to all digital platforms, financial accounts, and organizational archives. Specifically, the Executive Board shall maintain and manage a collective password manager to secure all organizational credentials.

Section 3: Responsibility

While all members of the Executive Board bear collective responsibility for the success of the handover process and the security of organizational resources, the **Chief Technology Officer (CTO)** is primarily responsible for the technical implementation and maintenance of the collective password manager and digital archives.

Article XII: History

1. **Constitution Created:** February 19th, 2026